

WEEK 7: GROUP DISCUSSION

Banking Sector Case: Using Landscapes to Rationalize Cybersecurity and Analytics Systems

Context

A large multinational bank operates across several regions, each maintaining its own cybersecurity and analytics tools. Over time, this has created a fragmented IT environment—multiple data warehouses, overlapping SIEM (Security Information and Event Management) systems, and redundant business intelligence platforms.

While each region's IT team has independently optimized local systems, the enterprise lacks a unified view of its digital ecosystem. Executives are increasingly concerned about:

- High operating costs from duplicated systems
- Inconsistent data quality and analytics results
- Security vulnerabilities due to unmonitored or outdated systems
- Compliance challenges with international data protection laws

Enterprise Architecture Challenge

The bank's EA team has been tasked with developing a comprehensive IT Landscape that maps all existing systems, applications, and data flows across business units. Their goal is to:

1. Identify redundant or underutilized systems.
2. Rationalize tools to reduce cost and complexity.
3. Improve cybersecurity posture through consistent visibility.
4. Support enterprise-wide analytics with secure, standardized data access.

Enterprise Architecture Activities

- Landscape Mapping: Architects document every major system, its owner, data sources, and dependencies.
- System Classification: Systems are tagged as Strategic, Maintain, Decommission, or Invest.
- Integration Visualization: Diagrams reveal how data moves between analytics tools and security platforms.
- Future Planning: The EA team proposes an IT Roadmap to consolidate systems into a single enterprise analytics and cybersecurity platform.

Outcomes

After rationalizing the IT landscape:

- The number of active cybersecurity tools dropped by 40%, reducing maintenance costs by millions annually.

- Analytics teams gained access to consistent, cross-border data streams for fraud detection and compliance reporting.
- Cybersecurity monitoring improved with unified threat intelligence and real-time data visibility.
- Executive leadership now has a clear architectural map guiding digital transformation and future technology investments.

Discussion Focus

Students should analyze:

- What systems and data the architects might discover.
- How documenting the Landscape improves both security and analytics.
- Which EA metrics (cost, risk, agility) best demonstrate the project's success.